

Tidy Components

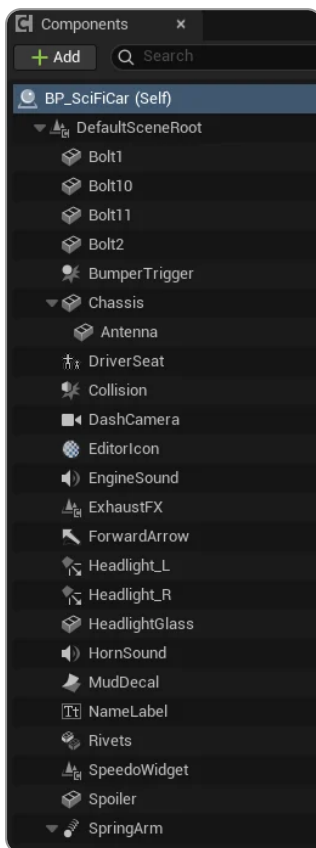
A step-by-step guide for people who have never installed an Unreal plugin before. Follow it from the top and you will have the plugin installed from Fab, switched on, and know every feature in about fifteen minutes.

Plugin version 1.1.0

Windows, macOS, Linux

Editor only, nothing ships in your game

BEFORE



AFTER



The same Blueprint, `BP_SciFiCar`, before and after. Before: one long list in Unreal's own order, with `Bolt10` ahead of `Bolt2` and every type mixed together. After: components are grouped by type, each type has a colored header with its count, and names sort with 2 before 10. The **Headlights** custom group has its own pink color, and components with no position, like movement, get a section of their own at the top.

01 What Tidy Components does

When you add components to an Actor or a Blueprint, Unreal lists them in an order that looks random, and it gets worse as the list grows. Tidy Components fixes that and adds a few tools you reach with a right-click.

- **Automatic sorting by type.** Every Components list is grouped by type (cameras, meshes, lights, sounds...) and each type is kept in alphabetical order, with numbers counted properly. You don't press anything.
- **Colors and header rows.** Each type has its own color and a header row with its name, like folders, so you can find things at a glance. Fold a header to hide what's under it, drag headers to reorder, and switch colors or headers off with one click if you prefer the plain look.
- **Sort Priority.** Pin the components you use most to the top of their list.
- **Custom Groups.** Keep the components you choose together under a name and a color of your choice, above or below the rest of the list.
- **Your choice of storage.** Groups and priorities are saved as component tags, or as editor-only data that never goes into your packaged game. A Tidy Data tool converts or removes them for whole folders.
- **Replace Component Class.** Turn a component into a different type (for example a Billboard into an Arrow) without rebuilding it by hand.
- **Alt+Drag duplicate.** In the Blueprint viewport, hold **Alt** and drag the move arrows to make a copy, the same way you copy Actors in a level.

GOOD TO KNOW

Sorting only changes how the list *looks* in the editor. Your Blueprints, levels and the finished game are not changed by it.

02 A few words you'll see

If you are new to Unreal, these are the terms this guide uses.

Plugin	An add-on that gives the Unreal Editor new features. It is a folder with a <code>.uplugin</code> file inside.
Fab	Epic's store for Unreal content (fab.com). What you get there appears in the Epic Games Launcher under <i>Fab Library</i> .
Project	Your game. It lives in a folder that contains a <code>.uproject</code> file, plus folders like <code>Content</code> and <code>Config</code> .
Engine version	The Unreal Engine release you use, such as 5.5 or 5.6. A plugin is installed separately for each version.
Actor	Anything you can place in a level: a lamp, a door, a character.
Blueprint	A reusable Actor you build in the Blueprint Editor, for example <code>BP_Lantern</code> .
Component	A building block inside an Actor: a mesh, a light, a sound, a collision box.
Component type	What kind of component it is, for example Camera, Static Mesh or Point Light. Unreal calls this its <i>class</i> .
Components panel	The list of components, shown at the top-left of the Blueprint Editor and at the top of the Details panel when you select an Actor in a level.
Details panel	The panel on the right of the Level Editor that shows the settings of whatever you selected.
Viewport	The 3D view where you see and move things.
Gizmo	The colored arrows (move), rings (rotate) or boxes (scale) that appear on a selected object.
Tag	A short text label you can attach to a component. Sort Priority and Custom Groups use them.

Custom group	A named set of components you pick yourself. Tidy Components keeps them next to each other in the list.
Header row	A row Tidy Components adds above a group, showing the group's name, color and how many components it holds. Its little arrow folds the group away. It is not a component and isn't saved.
Editor-only data	Information saved with your Blueprint or level that the editor uses but that is left out of your packaged game.

03 Before you start

You need four things. Take a minute to check them, because a mismatch here causes most install problems.

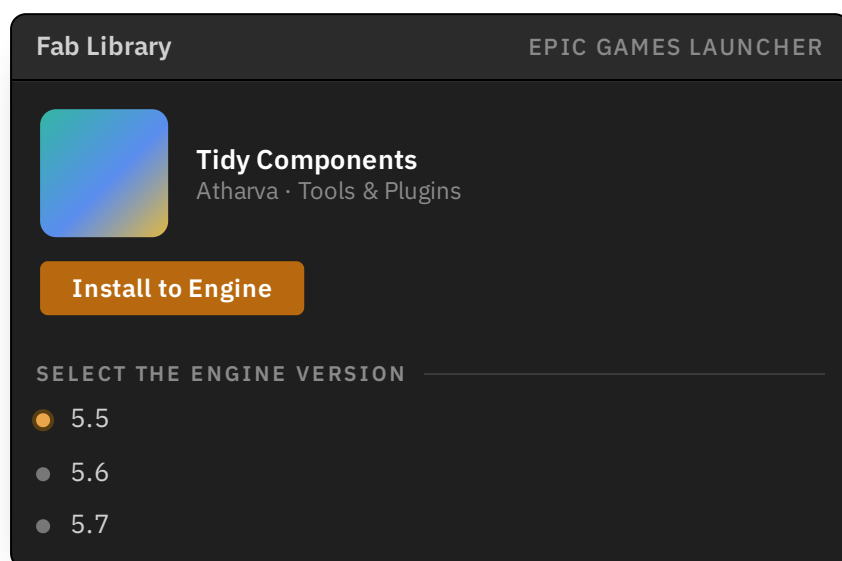
- 1 **Unreal Engine 5.5 or newer.** Open Unreal and go to **Help** > **About Unreal Editor**. The window shows your version, for example `5.5.4`. Only the first two numbers matter here (5.5).
You can also see it in the Epic Games Launcher under **Unreal Engine** > **Library**.
- 2 **Tidy Components in your Fab Library.** Buy it (or add it) on its Fab page while signed in with the same Epic account you use in the Epic Games Launcher. Each person who uses it needs their own copy.
- 3 **The Epic Games Launcher**, signed in with that account. It's the app you installed Unreal with.
- 4 **Unreal closed.** Save your work and close the Unreal Editor before you install. Unreal only looks for plugins when it starts.

TIP You don't need Visual Studio or any programming knowledge. It works in Blueprint-only projects too.

04 Install the plugin

The Epic Games Launcher does the copying for you. You do this once for each Unreal version you use.

- 1 **Open the Epic Games Launcher** and click **Unreal Engine** on the left, then the **Library** tab at the top.
- 2 **Scroll down to Fab Library.** It lists everything you own on Fab. Type **Tidy** in its search box to find **Tidy Components** quickly.
- 3 **Click Install to Engine** under Tidy Components. A small window asks which engine: pick your version, for example **5.5**, and click **Install**.
- 4 **Wait a moment.** The plugin is small, so it only takes a few seconds. To use it with another Unreal version too, repeat step 3 and pick that version.



Tidy Components in the Fab Library, with the engine versions it can be installed to. The exact look of the Launcher changes from time to time, but the button is always called **Install to Engine**.

WHERE IT GOES

The Launcher puts the plugin inside the engine (in `Engine\Plugins\Marketplace`), so it's available to every project on that version. It is not switched on anywhere yet; you do that per project in the next part.

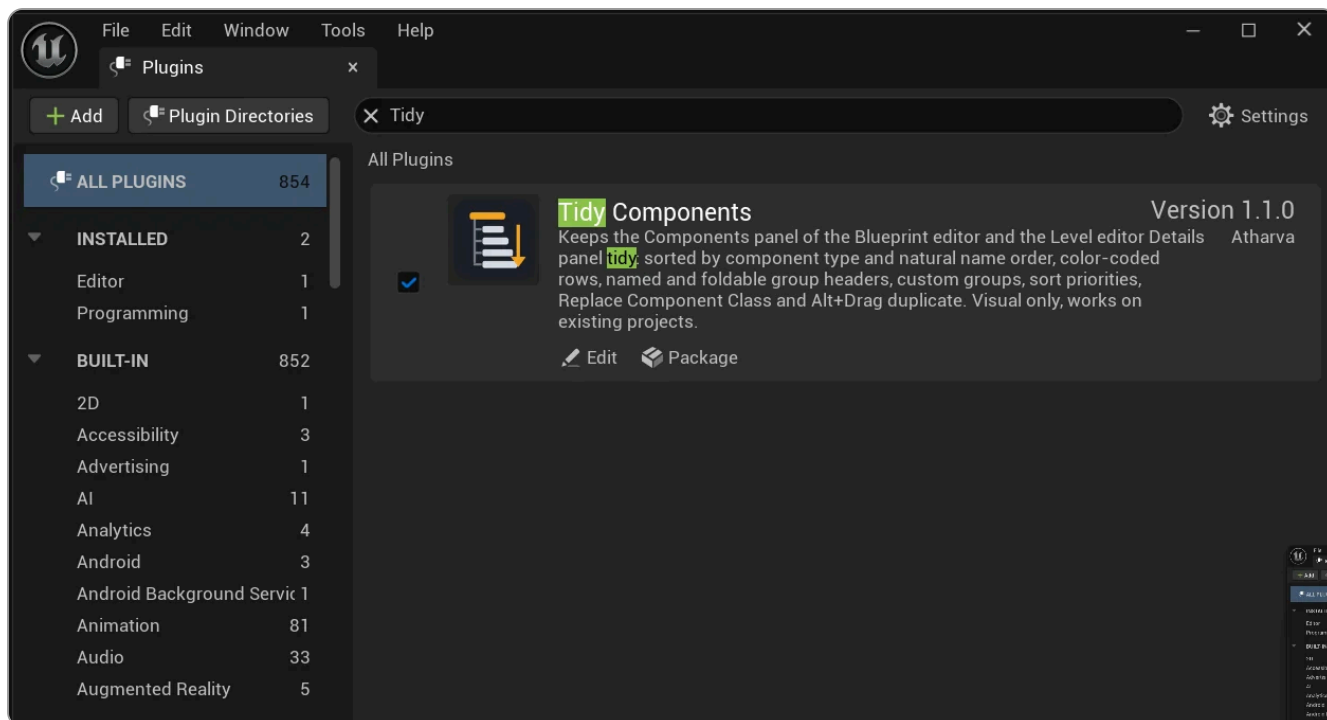
Got a zip instead?

If someone gave you a ready-made zip (for example a test build), close Unreal, make a folder called `Plugins` next to your project's `.uproject` file, and unzip it there so that `Plugins\TidyComponents\TidyComponents.uplugin` exists. The zip must be made for your Unreal version. Then continue with the next part.

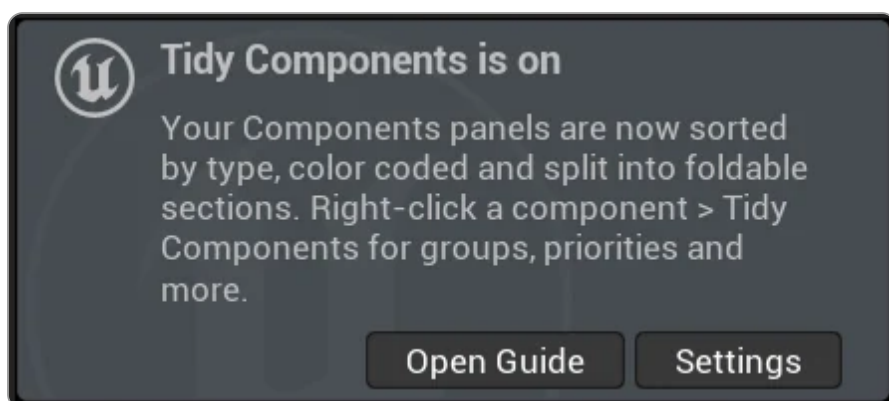
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Turn it on in your project

- 1 Open your project, then open **Edit** > **Plugins**.
- 2 Type **Tidy** in the search box at the top.
- 3 Tick the **Enabled** box on **Tidy Components**, then click **Restart Now**.
- 4 After the restart, a short message appears at the bottom-right: *Tidy Components is on*, with an **Open Guide** button (this guide) and a **Settings** button. That's it: open any Blueprint and the list is tidy.



Tidy Components in **Edit > Plugins**, with the box ticked.



The message you see after the restart.

For a second check, open **Window > Output Log** and type `TidyComponents` in its search box. You should see the line `LogTidyComponents: Tidy Components started.`

WORKING IN A TEAM

Turning a plugin on is saved in the project file. Teammates who open the project need Tidy Components installed as well; without it, Unreal offers to switch it off for them and the project still opens.

IF A POP-UP APPEARS

A message saying modules are "missing or built with a different engine version" means the plugin was installed for a different Unreal version. Click **No**, close Unreal, and install it for your version (see [Install from Fab](#)).

06 Automatic sorting by type

There is nothing to switch on. Open a Blueprint or click an Actor in your level and the Components list is already sorted: components are grouped by type, and each type is in alphabetical order. Here is a two-minute test so you can see it happen.

Try it

- 1 Open the Content Drawer with **Ctrl** + **Space**. Right-click an empty spot and choose **Blueprint Class**, then **Actor**. Name it **BP_SortTest** and double-click it to open it.
- 2 In the **Components** panel at the top-left, click **DefaultSceneRoot**, then click **+ Add**, type **Cube** and pick it. Do this four times, clicking **DefaultSceneRoot** first each time so every cube sits directly under it (a new component is attached to whatever is selected). Unreal names them **Cube**, **Cube1**, **Cube2** and **Cube3**.
- 3 Rename them one at a time, in this order. To rename, click the component, press **F2**, type the new name and press **Enter**.
Cube → **Wall**, **Cube1** → **Door**, **Cube2** → **Cube10**, **Cube3** → **Cube2**
- 4 Look at the list. It now reads **Cube2**, **Cube10**, **Door**, **Wall**. The list re-sorted itself after every rename, and **Cube2** comes before **Cube10** because 2 is smaller than 10.

5

Click `DefaultSceneRoot` , then use **+ Add** to add a **Camera** and a **Point Light**. The camera appears at the top, above the cubes. The light appears below all the cubes. That is the type order at work.

Now that the list mixes types, header rows appear (**CAMERAS, STATIC MESHES, LIGHTS**) and each row gets a color bar on its left. Click the **STATIC MESHES** header: all four cubes get selected. Click the small arrow at its left: the cubes fold away. Click it again to bring them back.

The sorting rules

RULE	EXAMPLE
Types stay together	All cameras, then all static meshes, then all lights, and so on (see the type order below)
Related types share a group	An Instanced Static Mesh is a kind of Static Mesh, so it sits in the Static Meshes group
Each exact type has its own block	Inside Static Meshes, the plain ones come first, then the Instanced ones, each block in name order
Names are sorted A to Z	Inside a block, <code>Mesh2</code> comes before <code>Mesh10</code> , and <code>audio</code> sits next to <code>Audio</code>
Children stay with their parent	A component attached to <code>Mesh10</code> is sorted inside <code>Mesh10</code> and never moves away from it
The dividing line stays	Components with a position in the world are above the line. Components without one (like movement or health logic) stay below it. Each side is sorted on its own.
Pinned items lead their type	A component with a Sort Priority goes to the top of its own type group. See the next part.
Colors and names show the groups	Each type has a color, and where types mix, a header row with its name. See Colors and header rows .
Your own groups come first	Components you put in a custom group stay together, above or below everything else. See Custom Groups .

The type order

Out of the box, the groups come in this order. Each group also takes in every type built on top of the ones listed, including your own Blueprint components.

GROUP	WHAT GOES IN IT
1 • Cameras	Camera, Cine Camera, Spring Arm
2 • Static Meshes	Static Mesh, Instanced Static Mesh, Hierarchical Instanced Static Mesh, Spline Mesh
3 • Skeletal Meshes	Skeletal Mesh, Poseable Mesh
4 • Other Meshes	Any other mesh type, for example Procedural Mesh
5 • Lights	Point, Spot, Rect, Directional and Sky lights
6 • Collision	Box, Sphere and Capsule collision
7 • Audio	Audio
8 • Effects	Niagara and Cascade particle systems, Decals
9 • Widgets	Widget (3D user interface)
10 • Child Actors	Child Actor
11 • Editor Helpers	Arrow, Billboard, Text Render
12 • Movement	Character, Projectile, Floating Pawn and Rotating movement
Last • Other	Everything else, still grouped by exact type

Change the type order

- 1 Open **Edit** > **Editor Preferences** and click **Tidy Components** under **Plugins** on the left.
- 2 Find **Type Groups** and click its arrow to open the list. Each entry has a **Name** and a list of **Classes**.

- 3 To move a group up or down, drag it by the handle on the left of its row. To add a group, click **+**, give it a name and pick one or more component types from the **Classes** drop-down. Your own Blueprint components appear in that list too.
- 4 The Components panels re-sort straight away. To go back to the original list, click the small reset arrow next to **Type Groups**.

TIP If a type fits two groups, the more specific one wins. For example, an Instanced Static Mesh matches both "Static Meshes" and "Other Meshes" and goes to Static Meshes. To check where a component lands, right-click it and hold your mouse over **Sort by Component Type**: the tooltip names its group.

Switch to plain alphabetical

If you prefer one A to Z list, right-click any component and click **Tidy Components > Sort by Component Type** to untick it. Click it again to go back to type order. You can also change **Sort Mode** in the settings.

Where it works

- **Blueprint Editor:** the Components panel at the top-left.
- **Level Editor:** click an Actor in your level. The component list at the top of the Details panel is sorted too.



The same car placed in a level. When you click it, the component list at the top of the Details panel is sorted and colored the same way.

TIP

Right after you add or rename a component, you may see the old order for a split second before the list tidies itself. That is normal.

07

Pin components to the top with Sort Priority

Some components you open all the time, like the main mesh or a collision box. Give them a priority number and they will always be listed first in their type group.

1

In the Components panel, **right-click** the component you want at the top. To do several at once, hold **Ctrl** and click each one first.

2

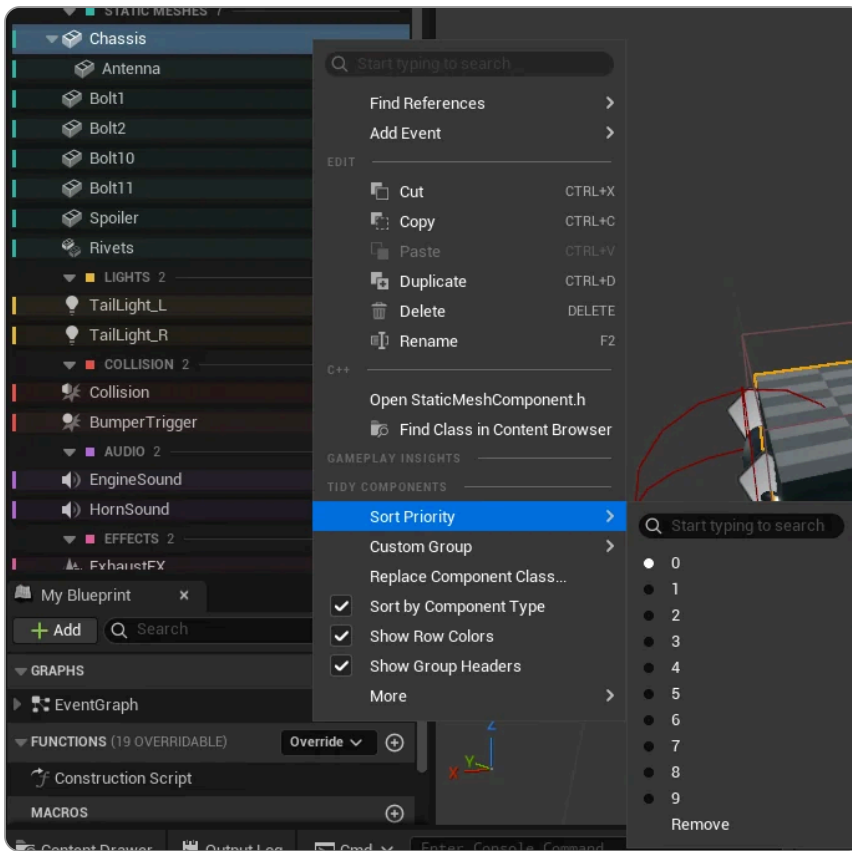
Find the section titled **TIDY COMPONENTS** in the menu that opens.

3

Point at **Sort Priority** and click **0**.

4

The component moves to the top of its type group, for example to the top of the static meshes. Save the Blueprint to keep the change.



The Tidy Components section of the right-click menu, with **Sort Priority** open for **Chassis**. The white dot shows the priority it has now; **Remove** takes it off again. The ticks show that sorting by type, row colors and header rows are on; click one to switch it off.

How the numbers work

- **Lower comes first.** Priority 0 is above priority 1, which is above priority 2, and so on.
- **Pinned components stay in their type group.** A pinned static mesh leads the static meshes; it doesn't jump above the cameras. In plain alphabetical mode, pinned components lead the whole list.
- **Components without a number** come after the numbered ones, in their normal order.
- **Two components with the same number** are sorted alphabetically between themselves.
- **A component only moves within its own group.** A child can't jump above its parent.



With priority 0, `Chassis` leads the static meshes, even though `Bolt1` comes first from A to Z. `Antenna` is attached to `Chassis`, so it stays right under it.

Remove a priority

Right-click the component and choose **Sort Priority** > **Remove**. It goes back to its alphabetical place.

What it does behind the scenes

Choosing a number adds a tag such as `CustomSort_0` to the component. You can see it by selecting the component and looking in the Details panel under **Tags** > **Component Tags**. You can also type a tag there yourself. Any whole number works, including big or negative ones like `CustomSort_-5`.

Prefer no tags? Switch **Storage** to **Editor-Only Data** and the number is saved out of sight instead. See [Where your groups are saved](#).

GOOD TO KNOW

The tag is saved with your Blueprint or level. It has no effect on your game unless your own code reads component tags.

If a component comes from a parent Blueprint, you'll see a message asking you to set its priority in that parent instead.

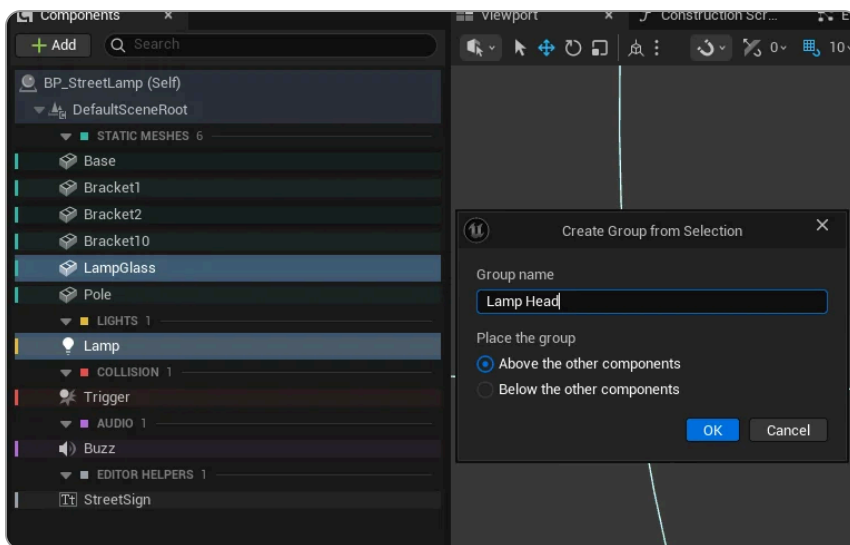
Keep components together with Custom Groups

Sometimes the type order isn't what you want. The glass, flame and glow of a lantern belong together, even though one is a mesh and two are lights. A custom group keeps the components you choose side by side under a name, and you decide whether the group sits above or below the rest of the list.

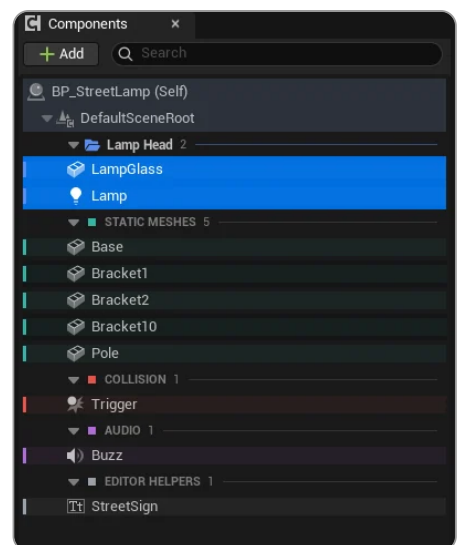
Make a group

- 1 Select the components.** Click the first one, then hold **Ctrl** and click each of the others.
- 2 Right-click** one of the selected components and choose **Tidy Components > Custom Group > Create Group from Selection...**
- 3** A small window opens with a **suggested name**. If the names start the same way (`LampA` , `LampB`) it suggests that start (`Lamp`); if the components are all one type it suggests the type (`Lights`). Keep it or **type your own**, for example `Lantern Parts` .
- 4** Choose **Above the other components** or **Below the other components**, then click **OK** (or press **Enter**).
- 5** The components move next to each other under a **header row** with a folder icon, the group's name and how many components it holds. The group gets its own color. **Save** the Blueprint to keep the group.

THE WINDOW



THE RESULT



In `BP_StreetLamp`, `LampGlass` and `Lamp` are selected and the group is named **Lamp Head**. The group sits above everything else under its own header, in its own color; then come the other components in their usual type order. Inside the group the usual rules still apply, so the mesh `LampGlass` comes before the light.

TIP If you type the name of a group that already exists, the components simply join that group.

Above or below: the position number

Every group has a position number. You rarely need to type it yourself, but it explains the order you see:

POSITION	WHERE THE GROUP GOES
-2	At the very top, above the group at -1
-1	Just above the ungrouped components
no group	All the ungrouped components, sorted by type as usual
1	Just below the ungrouped components
2	Below the group at 1

So negative numbers are above the other components and positive numbers are below them. A group you type `0` for sits right after the ungrouped components. Two groups with

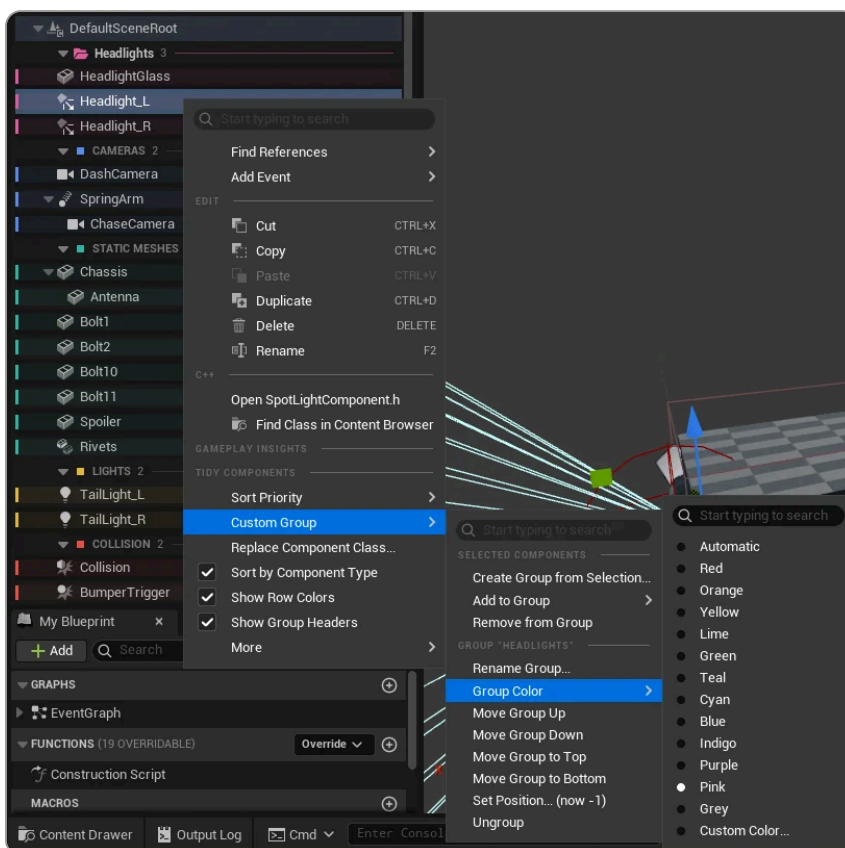
the same number are put in name order.

Move a group

Right-click any member of the group and open **Custom Group**. The lower part of that menu is about the group the component belongs to:

- **Move Group Up** and **Move Group Down** move it one step. A step can jump over the block of ungrouped components, so a group can go from below them to above them.
- **Move Group to Top** and **Move Group to Bottom** send it all the way.
- **Set Position...** lets you type the number yourself. The menu shows the current one, for example (*now -1*).

After a move, the plugin rennumbers all the groups (... , -2, -1, 1, 2, ...) so the numbers stay short.



The Custom Group submenu for `Headlight_L_L`, with **Group Color** open. The top part works on the selected components. The part headed **GROUP "HEADLIGHTS"** only appears when all the selected components are in the same group. The white dot marks the group's current color.

Change a group

TO...	DO THIS
Add more components	Select them, right-click › Custom Group › Add to Group › pick the group
Take components out	Select them, right-click › Custom Group › Remove from Group . The rest of the group stays.
Rename the group	Right-click a member › Custom Group › Rename Group... and type the new name. If you type the name of another group, the two groups become one.
Delete the group	Right-click a member › Custom Group › Ungroup . The components stay; they just go back to their normal place.

UNDO

Every group change can be undone with **Ctrl** + **Z**.

Rules to know

- **Same rules inside a group.** Members are ordered by type, then Sort Priority, then name, exactly like the rest of the list.
- **Only components under the same parent are arranged together.** A component attached to `StaticMesh10` stays under `StaticMesh10`. Group components that sit at the same level, for example all directly under `DefaultSceneRoot`.
- **The dividing line still wins.** Components with a position in the world and components without one (like movement) stay on their own side of Unreal's line, even when they share a group.
- **Each Blueprint has its own groups.** A group made in `BP_Lantern` doesn't appear in `BP_Door`. In a level, a group made on a placed Actor belongs to that Actor only.
- **Some components can't be changed here.** If a component comes from a parent Blueprint or from C++ code, it may be skipped. A message in the bottom-right corner tells you how many were skipped.

Header and color

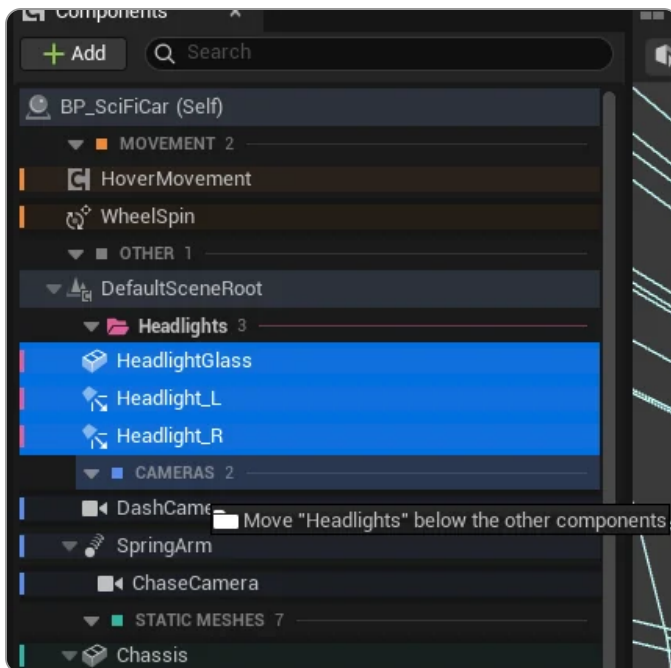
Each group has a header row: a folder in the group's color, its name and how many components it holds. **Click the header** to select the whole group (`Ctrl` +click adds it to what you already selected). Every member also gets a bar in the group's color on the left of its row. **Right-click the header** for all the group actions in one menu.

To change the color, right-click a member and open **Custom Group > Group Color**. Pick one of the 12 swatches, **Automatic** to let the plugin choose from the group's name, or **Custom Color...** to pick any color you like with Unreal's color picker. More about colors and headers in the [next part](#).

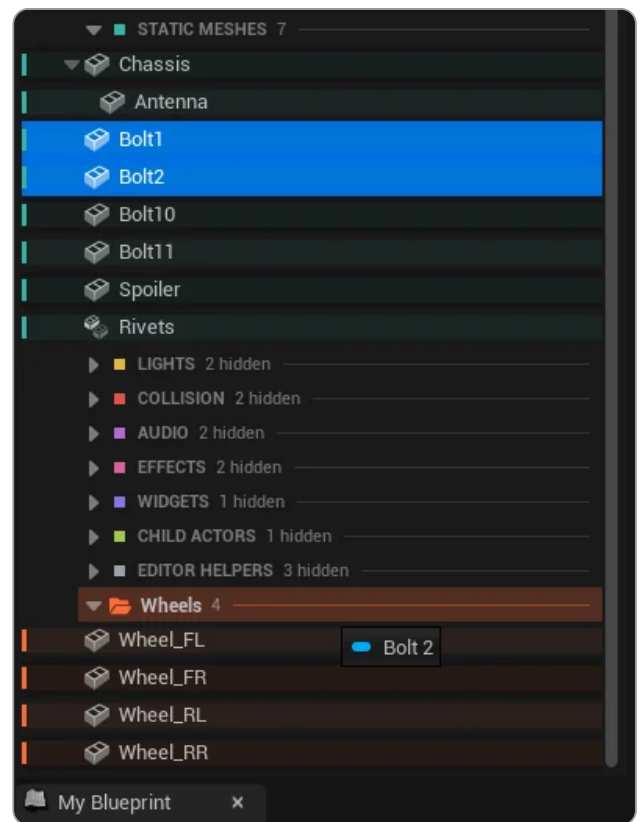
Move and fill a group by dragging

- **Move a group:** press on its header, drag it onto another group's header and let go. Drop on the top half of that header to go above it, on the bottom half to go below it. Drop it on a type header (like **STATIC MESHES**) to place it just above or below all the ungrouped components.
- **Add components:** select them in the list, then drag them onto the group's header. The header lights up and a label says how many will be added.

MOVE A GROUP



ADD TO A GROUP



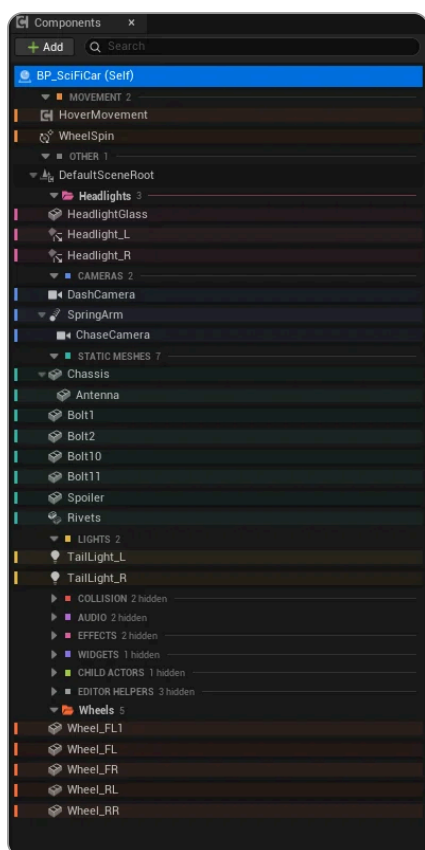
Left: the **Headlights** header dragged onto the bottom half of the **CAMERAS** header; the label says what will happen. Right: **Bolt1** and **Bolt2** dragged onto the **Wheels** header. Let go to finish; **Ctrl** + **Z** undoes it.

What it does behind the scenes

Each member gets a tag such as `TidyGroup:-1:#E05FA0:Lantern Parts`: the word `TidyGroup`, the position, the color, then the name (groups made with version 1.0.2 have no color part and simply get an automatic one). You can see it in the Details panel under **Tags > Component Tags**. Like Sort Priority tags, it is saved with your Blueprint or level and has no effect on your game unless your own code reads component tags. With **Storage** set to **Editor-Only Data**, no tag is added; see [Where your groups are saved](#).

09 Find things faster with colors and header rows

Tidy Components colors the Components list and splits it into named sections, a bit like folders. You don't have to switch anything on, and you can switch either part off with one click. Here is what you see and how to change it.



Every row has a color bar for its type or group, and every section has a header with its name and count. **Headlights** and **Wheels** are custom groups (folder icon) with colors of their own. The types in the lower half are folded, so the list fits on screen.

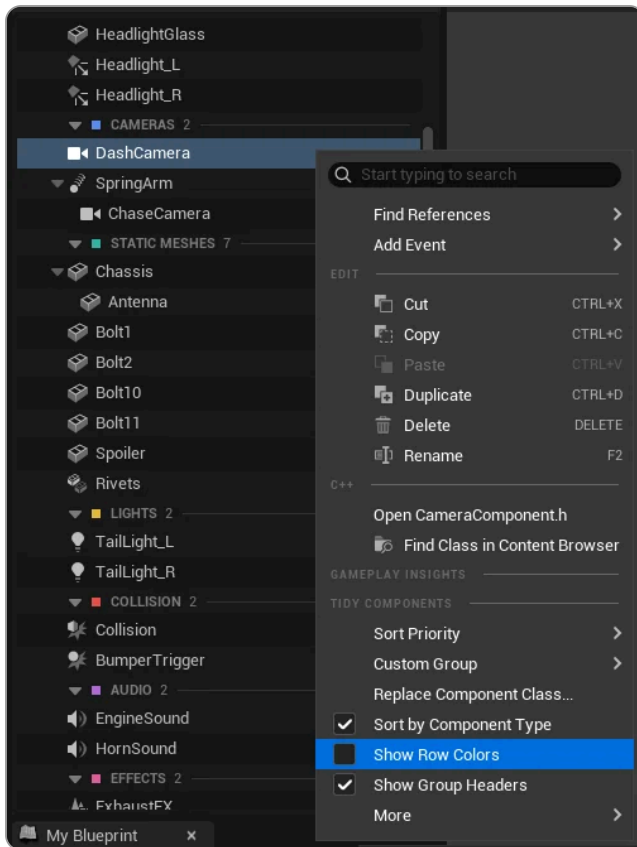
Turn colors or headers off (and on again)

- 1 Right-click any component and find the **Tidy Components** section.
- 2 Click **Show Row Colors** to remove the color bars, or **Show Group Headers** to remove the header rows. The tick disappears and the list changes straight away.

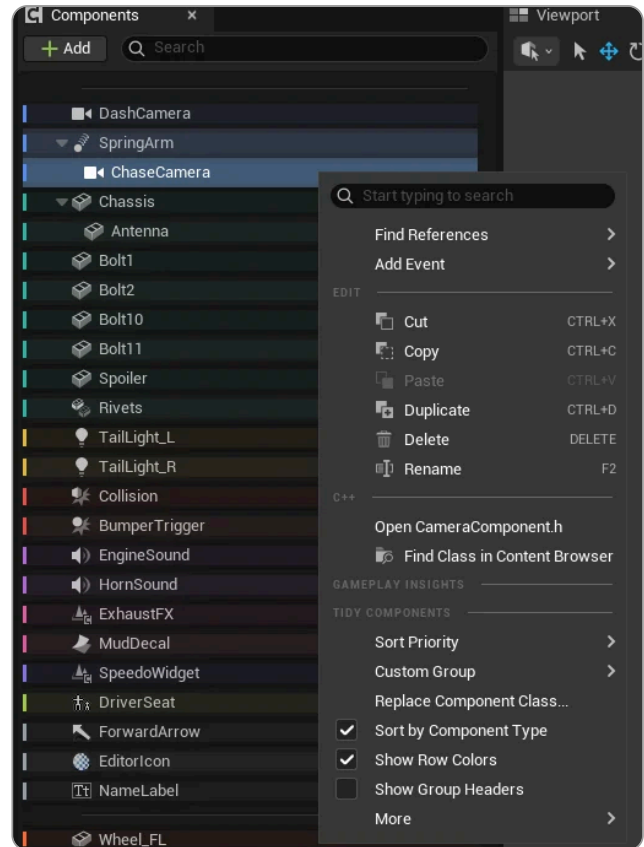
3 Click the same entry again to bring them back.

With the headers off, your custom groups are still kept apart by a thin line, so you can tell where one ends. Sorting keeps working either way. The same two switches are on every header's right-click menu and in the settings.

COLORS OFF



HEADERS OFF



Left: **Show Row Colors** unticked; the header rows stay. Right: **Show Group Headers** unticked; the color bars stay, and the **Wheels** group is still set apart by a thin line at the bottom.

What the colors mean

Every row has a thin bar on its left and a very light wash of the same color. Members of a custom group show the group's color. Every other component shows the color of its type:

 Cameras blue	 Static Meshes teal	 Skeletal Meshes cyan
 Other Meshes green	 Lights yellow	 Collision red
 Audio purple	 Effects pink	 Widgets indigo
 Child Actors lime	 Editor Helpers grey	 Movement orange

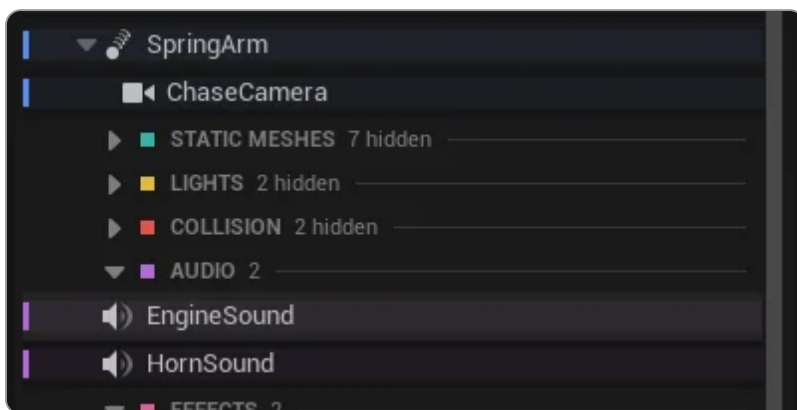
Components that fit no type group ("Other") have no color. Custom groups use the same 12 colors; a new group gets one that no other group in the list is using yet.

The header rows

- **Custom groups** always get a header: a folder in the group's color, the group's name, and how many components it holds.
- **Types** get a header, such as **STATIC MESHES 3**, wherever a list mixes two or more types. A list with only one type doesn't need one, so it gets none. That also means a single child under a parent never gets a header.
- **Click a header** to select everything under it. Hold **Ctrl** while you click to add them to what you already selected.
- **Right-click a header** for its own menu (below).
- Header rows are only drawn in the list. They aren't components, they aren't saved, and they don't change your Blueprint.

Fold a header

Click the small arrow at the left of a header, or double-click the header. Everything under it is hidden and the header shows how many components it hides. Click the arrow again to unfold it.



Folded headers. The arrow points right and the count tells you what's hidden (**STATIC MESHES 7 hidden**). The components are still there; they are only out of sight.

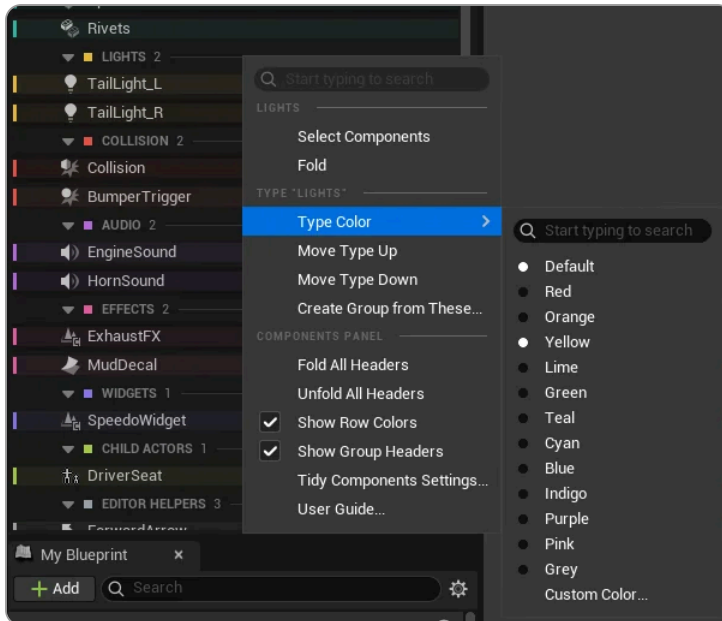
- **Folds are remembered** for each Blueprint and each placed Actor, even after you restart Unreal.
- **It opens by itself when needed.** If you select a hidden component some other way (by clicking it in the viewport, for example), its header unfolds so you can see it. Clicking a

folded header selects its components, so it unfolds too.

- **Fold everything at once:** right-click a component › **Tidy Components** › **More** › **Fold All Headers** (or **Unfold All Headers**).

The header's right-click menu

HEADER MENU



CUSTOM COLOR...



Right-click on a type header (here LIGHTS), with **Type Color** open. **Custom Color...** opens Unreal's color picker. A custom group's header shows the group's own actions instead (rename, color, move, ungroup and so on), followed by the same Components Panel part.

Drag headers to reorder

- **Custom groups:** drag a group's header above or below another group, as shown in [Custom Groups](#).
- **Types:** drag a type header onto another type header to change the type order, for example to list Lights before Static Meshes. This changes **Type Groups** in the settings, so every Blueprint follows the new order. **Move Type Up** and **Move Type Down** on the header's menu do the same one step at a time.

Change the colors

- **A type's color:** right-click its header › **Type Color**, then pick a swatch, **Custom Color...** for any color, or **Default** to go back. You can also do it in **Edit** › **Editor Preferences** ›

Plugins › **Tidy Components** under **Type Groups**. Groups you add yourself get a color automatically; that's also what you get if you make a color fully transparent.

- **A custom group's color:** right-click a member (or the group's header) › **Custom Group** › **Group Color**, then pick a swatch, **Automatic** or **Custom Color...** See [Custom Groups](#).

Make it quieter, or turn it off

SETTING	CHOICES
Show Row Colors	On or off: the same switch as in the right-click menu
Row Colors	Custom Groups and Types (starts as this) or Custom Groups Only
Row Tint Opacity	How strong the light wash behind colored rows is. 0 keeps only the bar.
Show Group Headers	On or off: the same switch as in the right-click menu
Group Headers	Custom Group and Type Headers (starts as this), Custom Group Headers, Divider Lines Only (the look of version 1.0.2), Off
Show Header Counts	On or off: the number after each header's name
Foldable Headers	On or off: the fold arrow on headers

GOOD TO KNOW

Colors and headers go with the automatic sorting. If you untick **Enable Auto Sort**, the list goes back to Unreal's own look.

Where your groups are saved

Custom groups and sort priorities are saved with your Blueprint or level, so they are still there tomorrow and for everyone who opens the file. You can choose how they are saved in **Edit > Editor Preferences > Plugins > Tidy Components > Storage**.

	COMPONENT TAGS (STARTS AS THIS)	EDITOR-ONLY DATA
Where it goes	The component's tags, like <code>TidyGroup:-1:Lantern Parts</code>	Out of sight, inside the component
Can you see it?	Yes, under Tags in the Details panel	Only under Asset User Data (advanced)
In your packaged game	Yes, like any tag. Harmless unless your code reads tags.	No, never
Without the plugin	The tags stay and can be edited by hand	Dropped when the file is saved without the plugin

Tidy Components always reads both kinds, so you can switch at any time and nothing gets lost. Whatever you change after switching is saved the new way.

Convert or clean up many Blueprints at once

The **Tidy Data** tool moves existing groups and priorities from one kind of storage to the other, or removes them.

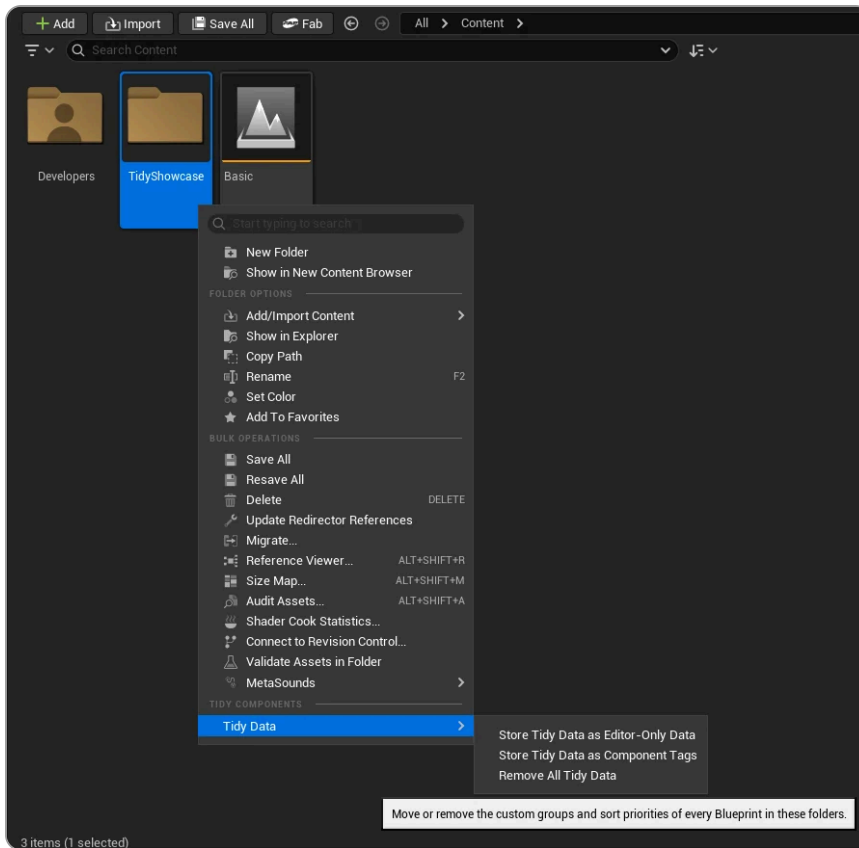
- 1 In the **Content Browser**, right-click one or more Blueprints, or a whole folder (it includes the folders inside it). In a level, you can right-click placed Actors instead.

- 2 Point at **Tidy Data** and pick what you want:

Store as Editor-Only Data, **Store as Component Tags**, or **Remove All Tidy Data** (this one asks first).

3

A message says how many components changed. **Save** the changed Blueprints (**File** › **Save All**) to keep the result, or press **Ctrl** + **Z** to undo it.



The **Tidy Data** submenu when you right-click a folder in the Content Browser. Blueprints and placed Actors get the same three entries.

For the Blueprint or Actor you are looking at right now, the same three actions are under **Tidy Components** › **More** › **Tidy Data of This Blueprint** (or *of This Actor*).

BEFORE YOU UNINSTALL

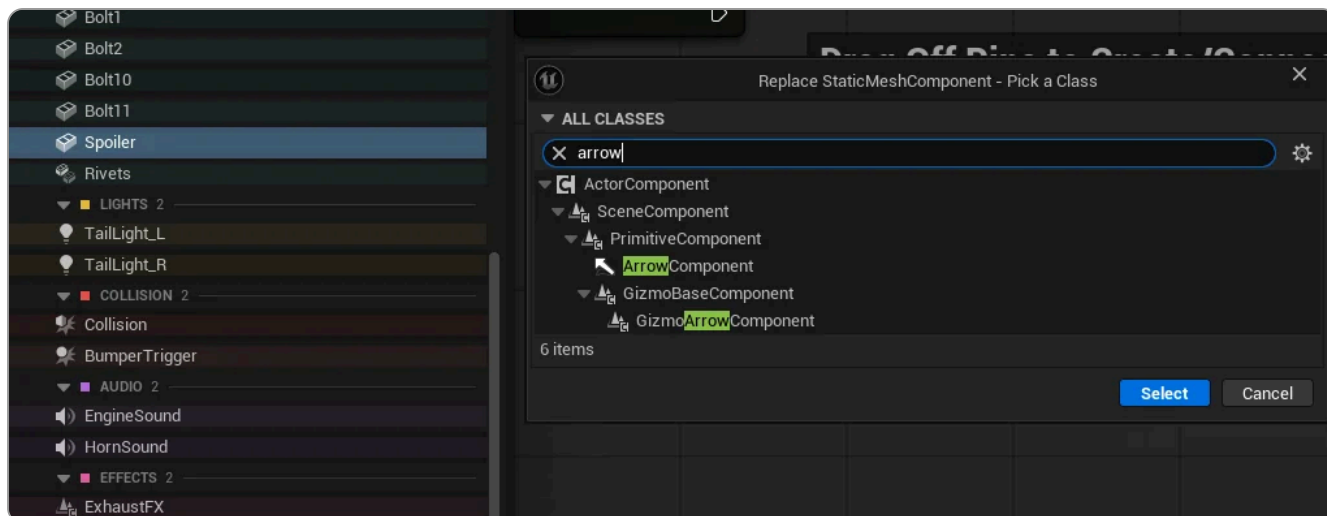
Editor-only data only survives while Tidy Components is installed. If you plan to remove the plugin, or teammates without it will edit and save these Blueprints, run **Tidy Data** › **Store as Component Tags** on your **Content** folder first (or **Remove All Tidy Data** if you don't need the groups any more), then save.

11

Change a component's type with Replace Component Class

Normally, changing a component's type means deleting it, adding a new one, and setting everything up again. This tool does it in one go and keeps the settings the two types share.

- 1 **Right-click** the component in the Components panel and choose **Tidy Components > Replace Component Class...**
- 2 A window opens with a list of component types. Type part of the name in the search box, for example **arrow**, and click **ArrowComponent**.
- 3 Click **Select**.
- 4 If the new type is quite different from the old one, a warning explains that some settings will be lost. Click **Yes** to go ahead or **No** to stop.
- 5 A message in the bottom-right corner confirms it, for example "Replaced with ArrowComponent (4 properties kept)".
- 6 In the Blueprint Editor, click **Compile**, then **Save**. Copies of this Blueprint already placed in your levels update after you compile.



Replace Component Class on `Spoiler`, a Static Mesh. The picker only lists types that fit: a component with a position (a scene component) can only become another one with a position. Type in the search box to find one quickly.

KEPT

- The component's name
- Its place in the list and anything attached to it
- Location, rotation and scale
- Tags, including Sort Priority
- Settings both types have (visibility, collision, mobility...)
- Blueprint nodes that use the component by name

LOST

- Settings only the old type had, like a Billboard's sprite image
- Blueprint nodes that call something only the old type could do show an error after Compile. Fix or delete those nodes.

UNDO

Changed your mind? Press **Ctrl** + **Z** once and the old component is back.

When the option is greyed out

Hold your mouse over the greyed-out entry and a tooltip tells you why. The usual reasons:

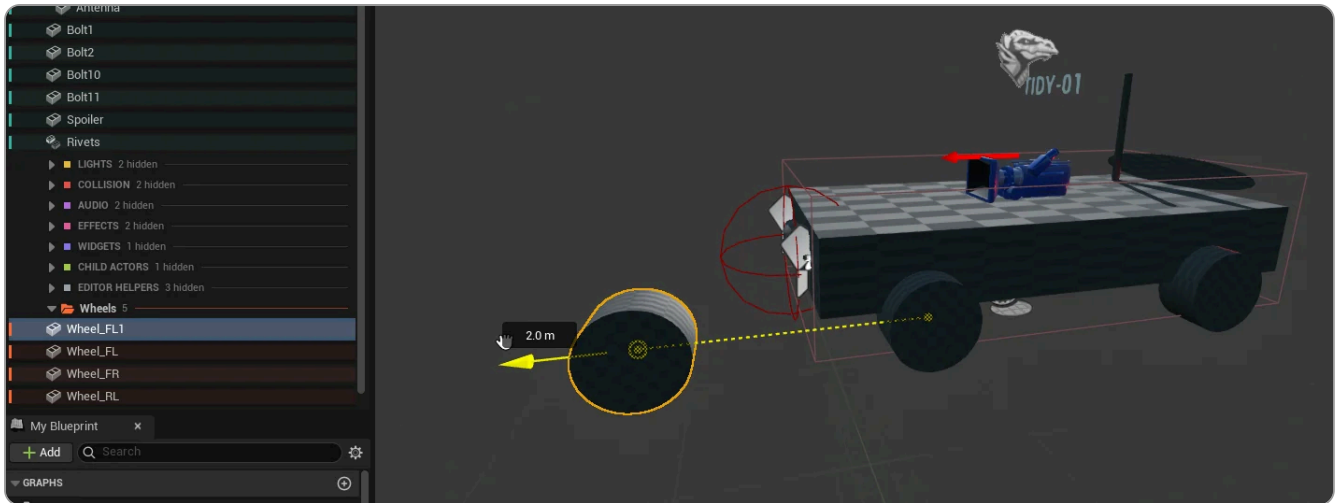
- More than one component is selected. Select just one.
- The component comes from a parent Blueprint or from C++ code. Open the Blueprint or class that adds it and replace it there.

- It is the `DefaultSceneRoot` . Drag another component onto it to make that one the root instead.
 - In a level, you can only replace components that were added to that one Actor in the level. For the others, open the Actor's Blueprint.
-

12 Copy while dragging with Alt+Drag

In a level you can hold `Alt` while moving an Actor to leave a copy behind. This plugin gives you the same trick for components inside the Blueprint Editor's viewport.

- 1 Open a Blueprint and click the **Viewport** tab.
- 2 Click the component you want to copy, either in the viewport or in the Components panel.
- 3 Press `W` to show the move arrows.
- 4 Hold `Alt` , move the mouse over one of the arrows until it lights up yellow, then press and drag.
- 5 Let go. The copy is where you dropped it and the original hasn't moved. The copy gets a new name with a number on the end. Press `F2` if you want to rename it.



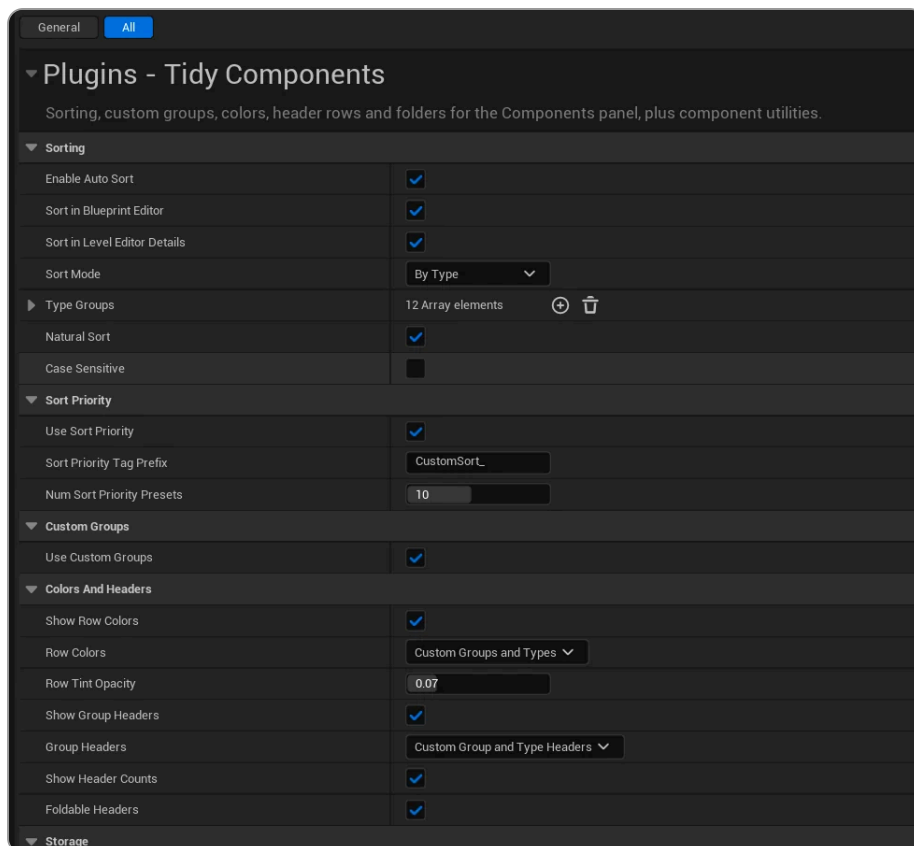
Hold **Alt** and drag an arrow of the move gizmo. The copy, **Wheel_FL1**, travels with your mouse and appears in the list straight away, in the same **Wheels** group as the original.

- **Press exactly on an arrow.** Alt+drag on empty space still turns the camera around, as usual.
- **It works with several components selected.** All of them are copied.
- **It works with the rotate (**E**) and scale (**R**) tools too.**
- **To undo,** press **Ctrl** + **Z** twice. The first press undoes the move, the second removes the copy.

HEADS-UP The copy is made as soon as you press the mouse button. If you Alt+click an arrow without dragging, you get a copy sitting on top of the original. Press **Ctrl** + **Z** to remove it.

13 Settings

Everything works without touching settings. If you want to change something, open **Edit > Editor Preferences**, scroll the list on the left down to **Plugins** and click **Tidy Components**. Changes apply straight away, no restart.



The top of the settings page. Each row is explained in the table below.

SETTING	STARTS AS	WHAT IT DOES
Enable Auto Sort	On	The main switch. Turn it off and the lists go back to Unreal's own order immediately.
Sort Mode	By Type	By Type groups components by type, then sorts each type by name. Alphabetical makes one A to Z list.
Type Groups	12 groups	The type order and each type's color. See Change the type order and Change the colors .
Sort in Blueprint Editor	On	Sort the Components panel in Blueprints.
Sort in Level Editor Details	On	Sort the component list in the Details panel when you select an Actor in a level.
Natural Sort	On	Count numbers as numbers (2 before 10). Off sorts letter by letter.

SETTING	STARTS AS	WHAT IT DOES
Case Sensitive	Off	On puts all capital letters before small ones.
Use Sort Priority	On	Put components with a priority first.
Sort Priority Tag Prefix	CustomSort_	The start of the priority tag. Change it only if CustomSort_ clashes with tags you already use.
Num Sort Priority Presets	10	How many numbers the Sort Priority menu offers (0 to 9 by default).
Use Custom Groups	On	Keep the members of each group together and show the Custom Group menu. Off ignores groups; their tags stay on the components.
Show Row Colors	On	The color bar on each row. Same switch as in the right-click menu.
Row Colors	Custom Groups and Types	Which rows get a color. Also: Custom Groups Only.
Row Tint Opacity	0.07	Strength of the light wash behind colored rows. 0 keeps only the bar.
Show Group Headers	On	Header rows with names. Same switch as in the right-click menu. Off leaves thin lines between custom groups.
Group Headers	Custom Group and Type Headers	Which headers. Also: Custom Group Headers, Divider Lines Only, Off.
Show Header Counts	On	Show how many components each header covers.
Foldable Headers	On	The fold arrow on headers.

SETTING	STARTS AS	WHAT IT DOES
Storage	Component Tags	How groups and priorities are saved. Also: Editor-Only Data. See Where your groups are saved .
Show Context Menu Entries	On	Show the Tidy Components section in the right-click menu.
Enable Alt+Drag Duplicate	On	Turn Alt+Drag copying on or off.
Show Welcome and What's New Messages	On	The short message after you install or update the plugin.
Panel Discovery Interval	2 s	Advanced. How often the plugin looks for newly opened panels as a backup. Leave it alone.
Verbose Logging	Off	Advanced. Writes extra lines to the Output Log. Useful when reporting a problem.

The two advanced settings are hidden until you click the small arrow at the bottom of the Advanced group. Settings are saved for you and for this project only.

14 Turn it off or remove it

For a moment

Untick **Enable Auto Sort** in the settings. Tick it again to turn sorting back on.

For one project

Open **Edit > Plugins**, search for **Tidy**, untick **Tidy Components** and click **Restart Now**.

Completely

- 1 **Keep or clean your groups first.** In the Content Browser, right-click your `Content` folder > **Tidy Data** > **Store as Component Tags** (keeps your groups as plain tags) or **Remove All Tidy Data**, then **File** > **Save All**. Skip this if you never changed **Storage** and don't mind the tags staying.
- 2 Turn the plugin off in each project (**Edit** > **Plugins**) and close Unreal.
- 3 In the Epic Games Launcher, go to **Unreal Engine** > **Library**. Under your engine version, open its list of **installed plugins** and remove **Tidy Components**. It stays in your Fab Library, so you can install it again at any time.

Tags you added (`CustomSort_0` , `TidyGroup:-1:Lantern Parts` and so on) stay on your components. They do no harm.

15 Problems and fixes

"Modules are missing or built with a different engine version"

The plugin was installed for a different Unreal version than the one this project uses. Click **No**, close Unreal, and in the Launcher's Fab Library use **Install to Engine** again, picking this project's version (see [Install from Fab](#)).

Tidy Components isn't in the Plugins window

It isn't installed for the Unreal version this project uses. Check the version under **Help** > **About Unreal Editor**, install it for that version from the Fab Library, then restart Unreal. Unreal only looks for plugins when it starts. If **Install to Engine** doesn't list your version, that version isn't supported yet.

The list isn't sorted

- Make sure **Enable Auto Sort** is ticked in the settings.

- Click another Actor and back, or switch to another tab and back.
- Still nothing? Tick **Verbose Logging**, open **Window > Output Log**, search for `TidyComponents` and send those lines through the support link on the plugin's Fab page.

A component is in the wrong group

Right-click it and hold your mouse over **Tidy Components > Sort by Component Type**. The tooltip shows which group it landed in and why, for example `Other > MyComponent`. Add its type to the group you want in **Type Groups** (see [Change the type order](#)).

I can't find the Tidy Components section in the right-click menu

Right-click directly on a component. Right-clicking empty space or the top row (the one ending in *(Self)*) shows a different menu. Also check that **Show Context Menu Entries** is ticked in the settings.

The members of my group aren't next to each other

Groups only arrange components that hang from the same parent. Check that all the members sit at the same level, for example directly under `DefaultSceneRoot`, and drag them there if they don't. Components below Unreal's dividing line (movement, health and similar) stay below it, even in a group.

The Custom Group menu is missing or greyed out

Right-click directly on a component, and make sure **Use Custom Groups** is ticked in the settings. The group actions (Rename, Move, Ungroup) only appear when every selected component is in the same group.

The header rows or colors look wrong, or take too much room

Right-click a component > **Tidy Components** and untick **Show Group Headers** and/or **Show Row Colors**. For something in between, set **Group Headers** to **Custom Group Headers** (no type headers) in the settings, or fold the headers you don't need. Sorting and groups keep working.

A header won't stay folded

Something keeps selecting a component under it, for example a click in the viewport. Click an empty spot in the list to clear the selection, then fold it again.

Tidy Data says there's nothing to change

The Blueprints you picked have no groups or priorities, or they are already stored the way you asked. Only Actor Blueprints have components; other kinds of Blueprints are skipped.

A teammate gets a message about a missing plugin

The project has Tidy Components turned on, but they don't have it installed. They can install it from their own Fab Library, or let Unreal switch it off for them; the project opens either way. If you use **Editor-Only Data** storage, ask them not to save Blueprints you share until they have it (see [Where your groups are saved](#)).

I don't want the welcome message

It only appears once after you install or update. To turn it off for good, untick **Show Welcome and What's New Messages** in the settings.

A component has no color

Its type isn't in any type group, so it lands in "Other", which has no color. Add its type to a group in **Type Groups** (see [Change the type order](#)).

Alt+Drag turns the camera instead of copying

Your mouse wasn't on an arrow when you pressed. Move it slowly over an arrow until the arrow turns yellow, then hold **Alt** and drag.

Replace Component Class is greyed out

Hover over it to read the reason, then see [When the option is greyed out](#).

I use a Mac or Linux

Install it from the Epic Games Launcher on that computer, the same way. The steps and menus are the same; use **Cmd** where this guide says **Ctrl** on a Mac.

Cheat sheet

Sort my components

Nothing to do. It happens by itself.

One A to Z list instead of types

Right-click › untick Sort by Component Type

Change the type order

Editor Preferences › Plugins › Tidy Components › Type Groups

Put a component first

Right-click it › Sort Priority › 0

Undo a priority

Right-click it › Sort Priority › Remove

Keep components together

Select them › right-click › Custom Group › Create Group from Selection...

Move a group up or down

Right-click a member › Custom Group › Move Group Up / Down

Delete a group

Right-click a member › Custom Group › Ungroup

Select a whole group or type

Click its header row

Change a group's color

Right-click a member › Custom Group › Group Color (swatch or Custom Color...)

Change a type's color

Right-click its header › Type Color

No colors / no headers

Right-click › Tidy Components › untick Show Row Colors / Show Group Headers

Hide a section

Click the arrow on its header (or double-click the header)

Reorder groups or types

Drag a header onto another header

Add components to a group

Select them › drag onto the group's header

Keep tags clean

Settings › Storage › Editor-Only Data

Convert or remove groups in bulk

Content Browser › right-click Blueprints or a folder › Tidy Data

Change a component's type

Right-click it › Replace Component Class... › pick › Select, then Compile and Save

Copy a component quickly

Viewport › **W** › hold **Alt** › drag an arrow

Pause sorting

Edit › Editor Preferences › Plugins › Tidy Components › untick Enable Auto Sort

Tidy Components 1.1.0 · © 2026 Atharva · Made for Unreal Engine 5.5 and newer.
Support: see the plugin's Fab page.